

NBA Alt Awards 2026 (Scraping)

Sumitro Datta

Awards

The “Home Cooking” Award (sponsored by Julia Child)

biggest PPG increase from road to home, min 50% of games played and 10 PPG (credit to livejamie and psychoM for the idea)

name	Away		Home		ppg_diff
	GP	PPG	GP	PPG	
Dillon Brooks	29	16.90	27	23.74	6.84
Kawhi Leonard	31	25.10	34	30.44	5.34
Brandon Ingram	39	19.59	38	23.45	3.86
Ace Bailey	35	11.83	37	15.65	3.82
Malik Monk	30	10.57	32	14.22	3.65

Alternatively: biggest game score increase from road to home, min 50% of games played

name	Away		Home		gmsc_diff
	GP	GmSc	GP	GmSc	
Dillon Brooks	29	8.81	27	14.73	5.93
Jalen Suggs	25	8.90	32	13.65	4.75
Lauri Markkanen	23	18.11	19	22.68	4.57
Ace Bailey	35	6.80	37	11.19	4.39
Cedric Coward	29	8.42	33	12.80	4.37

The “Jetsetter” Award (presented by Eric Bledsoe)

biggest PPG decrease from road to home, min 50% of games played and 10 PPG (credit to livejamie and psychoM for the idea)

name	Away		Home		ppg_diff
	GP	PPG	GP	PPG	
Ivica Zubac	27	15.93	21	11.76	-4.16
Tre Jones	31	15.90	34	12.38	-3.52
Jarrett Allen	31	16.90	25	13.44	-3.46
Jamal Murray	38	27.05	37	23.70	-3.35
Kon Knueppel	41	20.15	40	16.80	-3.35

Alternatively: biggest game score decrease from road to home, min 50% of games played

name	Away		Home		gmsc_diff
	GP	GmSc	GP	GmSc	
Immanuel Quickley	34	16.57	36	11.84	-4.73
Kyle Anderson	25	8.28	18	4.89	-3.39
Ivica Zubac	27	14.86	21	11.59	-3.28
Aaron Wiggins	32	8.37	33	5.17	-3.19
Devin Vassell	35	12.08	33	8.94	-3.13

The Bright Lights Merchant Award

biggest PPG increase from playing against teams below 45% win percentage to playing against teams above 55% win percentage, min 50% of games played and 10 PPG

name	<= 45% Win %		>= 55% Win %		ppg_diff
	GP	PPG	GP	PPG	
Stephen Curry	14	24.21	14	29.64	5.43
Nickeil Alexander-Walker	26	19.04	30	22.60	3.56
GG Jackson	18	10.17	21	13.38	3.21
Cam Thomas	10	11.60	19	14.79	3.19
Devin Vassell	21	12.62	26	15.50	2.88

Alternatively: biggest game score increase from playing against teams below 45% win percentage to playing against teams above 55% win percentage, min 50% of games played

name	<= 45% Win %		>= 55% Win %		gmsc_diff
	GP	GmSc	GP	GmSc	
Stephen Curry	14	16.40	14	21.65	5.25
Daniel Gafford	17	7.80	22	11.17	3.37
De'Andre Hunter	15	6.67	18	9.93	3.25
Ivica Zubac	13	11.32	19	14.39	3.07
Spencer Jones	22	2.91	23	5.91	3.00

“The Lights Were Brighter than Expected” Award

biggest PPG decrease from playing against teams below 45% win percentage to playing against teams above 55% win percentage, min 50% of games played and 10 PPG

name	<= 45% Win %		>= 55% Win %		ppg_diff
	GP	PPG	GP	PPG	
Lauri Markkanen	10	31.10	20	24.60	-6.50
De'Anthony Melton	16	16.62	20	10.85	-5.78
Santi Aldama	14	17.79	18	12.11	-5.67
Luka Doncic	24	36.12	23	30.96	-5.17
Alperen Sengun	26	23.77	27	18.89	-4.88

Alternatively: biggest game score decrease from playing against teams below 45% win percentage to playing against teams above 55% win percentage, min 50% of games played

name	<= 45% Win %		>= 55% Win %		gmsc_diff
	GP	GmSc	GP	GmSc	
Luka Doncic	24	30.13	23	23.15	-6.98
Isaiah Hartenstein	15	15.04	21	9.10	-5.94
Alperen Sengun	26	21.94	27	16.22	-5.72
Mark Williams	17	15.79	26	10.28	-5.51
De'Anthony Melton	16	12.66	20	7.30	-5.36

The “I Gotta Coach AND Ref?” Award (presented by Ace Attorney Phoenix Wright)

Biggest positive difference between actual successful challenges and expected successful challenges (credit to xfinityhomeboy & sleepyfox1312 for the original idea of best success rate on challenges and UBKUBK for the idea of most successful challenges, from <https://official.nba.com/2025-26-nba-coachs-challenge-reviews/>)

Team	Total Challenges	Successful Challenges	Success Rate	xSuccess	Delta
NYK	48	38	79.17%	30.33	7.67
UTA	64	47	73.44%	40.48	6.52
PHI	66	47	71.21%	41.79	5.21
LAL	73	51	69.86%	46.24	4.76
CLE	72	50	69.44%	45.63	4.37

The “I Did the Math, but Man am I Bad at Math” Award

Biggest negative difference between actual successful challenges and expected successful challenges (credit to livejamie, Necessary_Career_253 and andresalejandro1120 for the original ideas of worst success rate on challenges/most incorrect challenges)

Team	Total Challenges	Successful Challenges	Success Rate	xSuccess	Delta
DAL	42	18	42.86%	26.94	−8.94
TOR	50	26	52.00%	31.98	−5.98
MIL	44	23	52.27%	28.12	−5.12
ATL	53	29	54.72%	33.87	−4.87
IND	31	15	48.39%	19.81	−4.81

The “Just the Tip” Award

best jump ball win percentage, minimum 5 jump balls (credit to livejamie)

player	jump balls participated	win percent	jump balls participated percentile	win percent percentile	avg percentiles
Victor Wembanyama	72	88.89%	93.33%	97.95%	95.64%
Wendell Carter Jr.	102	67.65%	100.00%	86.15%	93.08%
Mark Williams	67	76.12%	92.31%	92.31%	92.31%
Deandre Ayton	84	67.86%	95.90%	86.67%	91.28%
Nic Claxton	86	62.79%	97.95%	80.51%	89.23%

The “Oops, I Dunked It Again” Award (sponsored by Britney Spears, presented by Gary Payton & Shawn Kemp)*

Most prolific alley-oop duo, both ways (credit to lactardenthusiast for the idea)

team_abb	p1	p2	count
LAL	1629028 Deandre Ayton	1629029 Luka Dončić	49
SAS	1641705 Victor Wembanyama	1642264 Stephon Castle	47
DET	1630595 Cade Cunningham	1631105 Jalen Duren	41
LAL	1629029 Luka Dončić	1629637 Jaxson Hayes	37
SAS	1628436 Luke Kornet	1642264 Stephon Castle	33

The “Master Baiter” Award (sponsored by Bass Pro Shops & Kleenex)

highest rate of 3-point shooting fouls drawn as percent of total 3-point attempts (PBPSstats.com) (credit to OhTheGrandeur for suggesting the change to a rate stat)

name	team	x3pt_sfd	x3pt_and_1s	x3pt_sfd_tot	FG3A	rate
James Harden	CLE	59	14	73	573	12.74%
Jerami Grant	POR	20	8	28	350	8.00%
Norman Powell	MIA	29	1	30	403	7.44%
Simone Fontecchio	MIA	20	4	24	327	7.34%
Austin Reaves	LAL	20	3	23	328	7.01%

The Yeet Award (presented by Jey Uso & Terry)

longest distance on 3-pointers attempted (PBPSstats)

Name	FG3M	FG3A	Avg3ptShotDistance
Stephen Curry	186	475	27.09
Andrew Nembhard	107	296	26.96
Payton Pritchard	212	562	26.90
LaMelo Ball	267	724	26.90
Luka Dončić	254	694	26.90

The “Hug the Line” Award (presented by Cris Carter)

shortest distance on 3-pointers attempted (PBPStats)

Name	FG3M	FG3A	Avg3ptShotDistance
John Collins	89	217	24.37
Harrison Barnes	137	353	24.53
Mikal Bridges	156	420	24.57
Keldon Johnson	97	268	24.60
OG Anunoby	157	407	24.64

The Wingman Award (presented by Iceman & Maverick)

most assists between teammates, weighing for equality using harmonic mean (PBPStats.com)

player1	player2	team	Totals			harmonic_mean
			P1-to-P2	P2-to-P1	Duo	
Jamal Murray	Nikola Jokić	DEN	170	147	317	157.67
Alperen Sengun	Kevin Durant	HOU	110	92	202	100.20
Dyson Daniels	Jalen Johnson	ATL	104	79	183	89.79
Jalen Johnson	Nickeil Alexander-Walker	ATL	138	61	199	84.60
Alperen Sengun	Amen Thompson	HOU	101	71	172	83.38

The “I’m a Tier 3 Sub!” Award (presented by Pokimane)

biggest discrepancies in assist combinations between teammates (PBPStats.com)

player1	player2	team	Totals			diff_between_sides
			P1-to-P2	P2-to-P1	Duo	
Cade Cunningham	Jalen Duren	DET	137	28	165	109
Deandre Ayton	Luka Dončić	LAL	15	109	124	94
Stephon Castle	Victor Wembanyama	SAS	130	40	170	90
Maxime Raynaud	Russell Westbrook	SAC	14	102	116	88
LaMelo Ball	Miles Bridges	CHA	133	48	181	85

The Stonks Award

contract overperformance by fewest contract \$ per 1 VORP, excluding players with ≤ 4 years of experience and less than a minimum salary (credit to memeticengineering for the idea)

player	salary	vorp	vorp_per_million
Neemias Queta	\$2.350M	2.4	1.0215
Sandro Mamukelashvili	\$2.461M	2.1	0.8532
Javonte Green	\$2.296M	1.5	0.6532
Jordan Goodwin	\$2.350M	1.5	0.6384
Luka Garza	\$2.461M	1.2	0.4875

Alternatively: salary is at least 5% of the salary cap

player	salary	vorp	vorp_per_million	percent_of_cap
Deni Avdija	\$14.375M	3.5	0.2435	9.30%
Shai Gilgeous-Alexander	\$38.333M	7.8	0.2035	24.79%
Tre Jones	\$8.000M	1.5	0.1875	5.17%
Luke Kornet	\$11.000M	2.0	0.1818	7.11%
Nikola Jokić	\$55.225M	9.2	0.1666	35.71%

The Rotation Awards

I value depth over one solitary star (it's a rotation after all). My attempt to make this more objective than past years:

- Get position estimates from Basketball-Reference
 - players with most minutes at PG & SG: guard
 - players with most minutes at SG & SF or SF & PF: wing
 - players with most minutes at PC & C: big
 - exceptions: all players greater than 7 foot are bigs and all players less than 6 foot are guards
- Rank teams based on highest positional VORP without positional VORP leader

The Best Guard Rotation Award (sponsored by Buckingham Palace)

East Guards				West Guards			
player	g	mp	vorp	player	g	mp	vorp
BOS - 3.4				PHO - 3.3			
Derrick White	77	2625	3.5	Collin Gillespie	80	2282	2.6
Payton Pritchard	79	2556	2.8	Grayson Allen	51	1467	1.5
Anfernee Simons	49	1202	0.8	Jordan Goodwin	70	1572	1.5
MIA - 2.1				Jamaree Bouyea	46	644	0.3
Norman Powell	58	1717	1.5	OKC - 3.1			
Dru Smith	70	1141	1.2	Shai Gilgeous-Alexander	68	2259	7.8
Davion Mitchell	70	2000	0.6	Isaiah Joe	71	1507	1.7
Kasparas Jakucionis	53	945	0.4	Cason Wallace	77	2046	1.7
NYK - 1.6				HOU - 2.4			
Jalen Brunson	74	2590	3.3	Amen Thompson	79	2953	3.4
Miles McBride	41	1080	0.9	Reed Sheppard	82	2147	2.5
Jose Alvarado	28	474	0.4	JD Davison	28	218	0.0
Tyler Kolek	62	727	0.3	Aaron Holiday	57	781	-0.1
CLE - 1.3				SAS - 2.1			
James Harden	26	879	1.3	De'Aaron Fox	72	2231	2.4
Craig Porter Jr.	64	1148	1.2	Stephon Castle	68	2038	2.0
Lonzo Ball	35	728	0.2	Jordan McLaughlin	44	282	0.2
Darius Garland	26	792	0.1	Lindy Waters III	40	285	-0.1
Tyrese Proctor	50	545	-0.1	MIN - 1.4			
Dennis Schröder	30	641	-0.1	Donte DiVincenzo	82	2494	1.7
ATL - 1.1				Bones Hyland	71	1177	1.1
Nickeil Alexander-Walker	78	2603	2.1	Ayo Dosunmu	24	694	0.6
CJ McCollum	41	1182	0.9	Mike Conley	54	991	0.2
Trae Young	10	280	0.3	Rob Dillingham	35	326	-0.5
Vít Krejčí	46	1028	0.2				
Gabe Vincent	24	320	-0.1				
Keaton Wallace	53	536	-0.1				

The Best Wing Rotation Award (presented by Lou Williams, sponsored by Magic City)

East Wings				West Wings			
player	g	mp	vorp	player	g	mp	vorp
NYK - 4.9				SAS - 4.0			
Mikal Bridges	82	2692	3.2	Julian Champagnie	82	2266	1.9
Josh Hart	66	1994	2.5	Keldon Johnson	82	1911	1.4
OG Anunoby	67	2224	2.3	Dylan Harper	69	1558	1.3
Landry Shamet	51	1171	0.5	Devin Vassell	67	2044	1.3
Mohamed Diawara	69	634	0.0	Carter Bryant	71	818	-0.2
Jordan Clarkson	72	1279	-0.4	GSW - 3.6			
CHO - 4.0				Jimmy Butler	38	1182	2.3
Kon Knueppel	81	2551	3.1	Brandin Podziemski	82	2333	1.3
Miles Bridges	77	2387	1.9	Gary Payton II	73	1142	1.1
Brandon Miller	65	1968	1.8	Moses Moody	60	1540	0.7
Pat Connaughton	42	297	0.2	Gui Santos	68	1395	0.5
Liam McNeeley	31	368	0.1	Buddy Hield	44	768	0.2
Sion James	82	1843	0.0	Will Richard	69	1377	0.1
DET - 3.7				Malevy Leons	25	276	-0.1
Ausar Thompson	73	1896	2.4	Nate Williams	14	239	-0.2
Javonte Green	82	1446	1.5	LAL - 2.6			
Duncan Robinson	77	2113	1.5	LeBron James	60	1989	2.8
Caris LeVert	60	1154	0.5	Austin Reaves	51	1762	2.1
Kevin Huerter	25	512	0.3	Jake LaRavia	82	2061	0.4
Ron Holland	78	1551	0.0	Luke Kennard	32	737	0.3
MIA - 3.7				Jarred Vanderbilt	65	1128	0.1
Andrew Wiggins	68	2063	1.7	Dalton Knecht	54	553	-0.2
Tyler Herro	33	1033	1.1	OKC - 2.3			
Jaime Jaquez Jr.	75	2121	1.1	Ajay Mitchell	57	1473	1.4
Simone Fontecchio	70	1173	0.7	Alex Caruso	56	1020	1.0
Pelle Larsson	70	1849	0.4	Jalen Williams	33	936	1.0
Myron Gardner	45	411	0.3	Aaron Wiggins	65	1414	0.4
Keshad Johnson	32	280	0.1	Jared McCain	30	540	0.1
BOS - 3.3				Luguentz Dort	69	1849	0.0
Jaylen Brown	71	2443	3.3	Brooks Barnhizer	40	348	-0.1
Sam Hauser	78	1934	1.3	PHO - 1.9			
Baylor Scheierman	77	1429	0.9	Devin Booker	64	2146	2.3
Jordan Walsh	68	1212	0.7	Royce O'Neale	78	2213	1.5
Ron Harper Jr.	29	318	0.3	Ryan Dunn	70	1355	0.4
Hugo González	74	1084	0.1	Jalen Green	32	828	0.2
				Amir Coffey	16	225	0.1
				Isaiah Livers	36	347	0.0
				Dillon Brooks	56	1702	-0.1

The Best Big Rotation Award (presented by Tom Hanks, sponsored by Cadbury and Sex and the City)

East Bigs				West Bigs			
				player	g	mp	vorp
player				OKC - 4.3			
TOR - 4.2				Chet Holmgren	69	1997	3.1
				Isaiah Hartenstein	47	1137	1.8
Scottie Barnes	80	2681	4.2	Jaylin Williams	65	1277	1.5
Sandro Mamukelashvili	80	1751	2.1	Kenrich Williams	56	855	0.5
Collin Murray-Boyles	57	1246	1.0	Branden Carlson	42	488	0.4
Jakob Poeltl	46	1149	1.0	Ousmane Dieng	27	295	0.1
Jonathan Mogbo	40	249	0.1	MIN - 3.4			
DET - 3.9				Julius Randle	79	2610	2.3
Jalen Duren	70	1976	3.5	Rudy Gobert	76	2380	1.8
Paul Reed	65	901	1.6	Naz Reid	77	2007	1.5
Tobias Harris	63	1746	1.5	Joan Beringer	40	314	0.2
Isaiah Stewart	58	1317	0.7	SAS - 3.0			
BOS - 3.0				Victor Wembanyama	64	1866	6.0
Neemias Queta	76	1926	2.4	Luke Kornet	68	1430	2.0
Luka Garza	69	1118	1.2	Harrison Barnes	77	1986	1.0
Jayson Tatum	16	522	0.9	Kelly Olynyk	42	360	0.2
Josh Minott	33	526	0.6	Jeremy Sochan	28	358	-0.1
Nikola Vučević	16	338	0.2	UTA - 2.0			
CLE - 2.9				Lauri Markkanen	42	1443	1.6
Evan Mobley	65	2074	2.6	Jusuf Nurkić	41	1083	0.9
Jarrett Allen	56	1519	1.8	Kyle Filipowski	77	1801	0.4
Dean Wade	59	1318	0.7	Kevin Love	37	613	0.3
Thomas Bryant	60	732	0.4	Blake Hinson	14	285	0.1
CHO - 2.4				Oscar Tshiebwe	27	448	0.0
				POR - 1.9			
Moussa Diabaté	73	1899	1.8	Donovan Clingan	77	2094	2.6
Ryan Kalkbrenner	69	1479	1.4	Robert Williams	59	1008	1.7
Grant Williams	36	711	0.7	Toumani Camara	82	2731	0.7
Tidjane Salaün	37	575	0.2	Duop Reath	32	258	0.1
				Yang Hansen	43	300	-0.6